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Chapter 2

Data Dictionary



Data Dictionary Overview

The data dictionary is a list of fields set up to hold information necessary for the creation and generation of reports in Financial Manager. Some of the fields are defined by the system and may not be updated or deleted, others may be user-defined.

Each data dictionary field consists of:

- Type - system or user defined
- Field name - identifier of the field in Financial Manager
- Description - the description of the above field

System-defined data dictionary fields include:

- Account identification and description data
- Actual, budgeted and statistical values by period and year-to-date
- Application constants such as company name, reporting period, report data and time

User-defined data dictionary fields might include:

- Use of intermediate calculations, which may include constant values
- Variable period numbers from which data may be used

The Data Dictionary System-defined Fields

The installation of Financial Manager includes the dictionary of defined fields. All these fields are easily recognisable because they include an underscore, and their type is 'System'.

System-defined Data Dictionary Fields

- Account code (12, 20, 30, 40, 50 characters)
- The appropriate length of the account code must be selected, since the length of accounts may vary. You have five lengths up to which the account code may extend. Remember to allow for level separators if the view is not the short account code.
- Account description (20, 30, 40, 50, 60, 70, 79 characters)
- The appropriate length of the descriptions for the accounts should be selected to fit into the format of the report. You have seven lengths up to which the account description may extend. The system default descriptions, with comma separators, will be used, as it will for views other than the short code view.

For the short code view, the 20 character description is taken for the short description as entered in the General Ledger Chart of Accounts maintenance procedure.

- Account level code for position in view (up to 15 characters)
- If the report is to show the account level codes used within a view as separate fields, then fields 1-9 contain the level code that corresponds to that position within the view. Each field is 15 characters in length.
- Account level code (up to 9 or 15 characters)
- If the report is to show account level codes as separate fields, then fields 1-9 contain the level code that corresponds to that position within the account. Levels 1-4 are 9 characters in length, while levels 5-9 are 15 characters.
- Account level code description for a view (20 characters)
- This field (1-9) contains the description of the level code that corresponds to that position of a view. Each field is 20 characters in length.
- Account level code description (20 characters)
- This field (1-9) contains the description of the level code that corresponds to that position within the account. Each field is 20 characters in length.
- Run-time account modifier (15, 20, 30, 40, 50 characters)

When preparing to print a report you are offered the chance to modify the specifications of the account codes specified when defining the account. By specifying the dictionary items, the modifier input at the next runtime will be printed. The length should match the length of the view.

The appropriate length of the account codes, or account codes within an account range or view, must be selected, since the length of accounts may vary. You have five lengths up to which they may extend. Remember that any account code separators will occupy one character each of the account.

- Base currency alternative year-to-date credits (15,2 numerics)
- Base currency alternative year-to-date debits (15,2 numerics)

- Base currency alternative year-to-date net (15,2 numerics)
- Base currency alternative year-to-date budget 1 (15,2 numerics)
- Base currency alternative year-to-date budget 2 (15,2 numerics)
- Values for the above will be printed in a format with two decimal places.

For multi-currency transactions, the prime values - held in currencies other than the General Ledger company's base currency - may be printed with their base equivalents. These fields are displayed only if the company is multi-currency. The base fields are prefixed 'BS' followed by an underscore, the prime fields 'PR' followed by an underscore and the base equivalent fields 'PE followed by an underscore'.
- Base currency code (3 characters)
- Base currency description (full) (35 characters)
- Base currency description (short) (10 characters)
- Base currency period net (15,2 numerics)
- Base currency period net budget 1 (15,2 numerics)
- Base currency period net budget 2 (15,2 numerics)
- Base currency period credits (15,2 numerics)
- Base currency period debits (15,2 numerics)
- Base currency revised budget 1 (15,2 numerics)
- Actual is printed for a period earlier than the current period; budget for a period the same as or after the current General Ledger period.
- Base currency revised budget 2 (15,2 numerics)
- Actual is printed for a period earlier than the current period; budget for a period the same as or after the current General Ledger period.
- Base currency fiscal year-to-date credits (15,2 numerics)
- Base currency fiscal year-to-date debits (15,2 numerics)
- Base currency fiscal year-to-date (15,2 numerics)
- Base currency fiscal year-to-date net budget 1 (15,2 numerics)
- Base currency fiscal year-to-date net budget 2 (15,2 numerics)
- Company code (2 characters)
- The company code for the general Ledger company
- Company name (35 characters)
- The name given to the General Ledger company
- Line text (10, 20, 30, 40, 50, 60 characters)
- Used when you want to specify the printing of specific text on specific lines.
- Page number (4 characters)
- Report run period (5 characters)

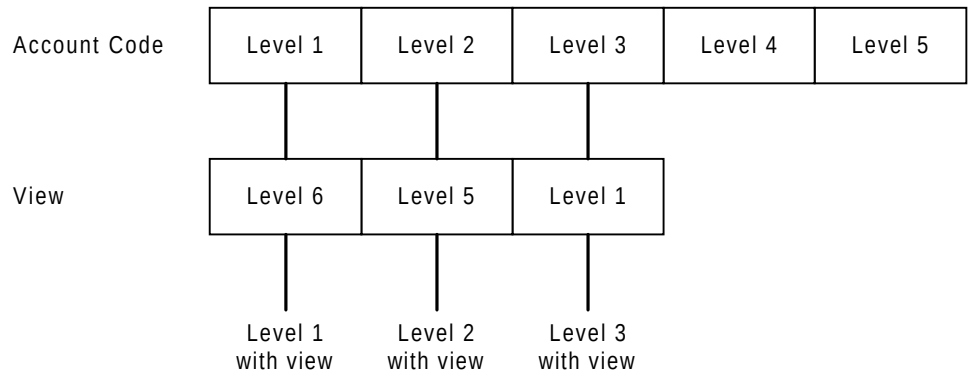
- Quantity period net (11,3 numerics)
- Quantity period net budget 1 (11,3 numerics)
- Quantity period net budget 2 (11,3 numerics)
- Quantity revised budget 1 (11,3 numerics)
- Actual is printed for a period earlier than the current period; budget for a period the same as or after the current General Ledger period.
- Quantity revised budget 2 (11,3 numerics)
- Actual is printed for a period earlier than the current period; budget for a period the same as or after the current General Ledger period.
- Quantity fiscal year-to-date (11,3)
- Quantity fiscal year-to-date budget 1 (11,3)
- Quantity fiscal year-to-date budget 2 (11,3)
- Report description (50 characters)
- Report name (10 characters)
- Report control codes A to E (3 characters)
- Report control code descriptions A to E (20 characters)
- Descriptions allocated to the report control codes.
- Report run date (8 characters)
- Report run month (2 characters)
- Report run time (8 numerics)
- Report run year (2 characters)
- User name

Following these standard system-defined fields is a list of any user-defined fields you have set up in Financial Manager. On entering the data dictionary, you are taken to the first user-defined field. Use the Roll Keys to roll up to see further user-defined fields, or roll down to see the system-defined fields.

Level Codes and their Descriptions

Account level codes and the associated descriptions can be printed on reports. If a view is being printed (particularly across ledger views), it is more logical to print the level code relevant to its position in the view than to print its sequential position in the account.

For example:



User-Defined Data Dictionary Fields Definition

This procedure allows you to create your own user-defined data dictionary fields so that you can customise your report formats to meet your business requirements.

User dictionary items are based on standard dictionary items and are positioned at the end of the standard Financial Manager dictionary.

Maintain Data Dictionary Fields Selection Screen

 Select the Data Dictionary option.

The following screen is displayed.

FM010	E1 - Demonstration Company	USER ED3	6/01/94 9:50:02
Maintain Data Dictionary			
Opt	Type	Field name	Description
	System	RUN_DATE	Report Run Date
	System	RUN_MONTH	Report Run Month
	System	RUN_TIME	Report Run Time
	System	RUN_YEAR	Report Run Year
	System	USER_NAME	User Name
User field to add . . : <u>MONTH VAR</u>			
1=Select field to maintain			
F3=Return to menu			

Fields:

User Field To Add

To amend an existing field:

Enter the field name, or enter 1 against the name of the field. (Roll to display other fields).

To create a new field:

Enter your choice of name. It must not contain an underscore _.

 Having entered a new field name, press **Enter** and the Maintain Data Dictionary Screen Field Names screen is displayed.

Maintain Data Dictionary Screen Field Names



This screen is displayed when you have entered a new field name in the Maintain Data Dictionary Fields Selection Screen and pressed **Enter**.

When you first enter this screen, the end of the list of system-defined fields is displayed at the bottom half of the screen so that any existing user-defined fields can be accessed easily for maintenance purposes. Roll Down to see the system-defined fields, Roll Up to see any further user-defined fields.

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RW010              Z1 - GB Demonstration Company      USER GBJBA1MS   24/10/97
                                                    10:42:03

Maintain Data Dictionary for Field Name RUN-MONTH

Description : Quarterly
Length . . . : 15 Decimal places . . : 2

Calculation of field:
Op.  Field Name  Period  Year  Period  Budget  Curr-
   =   BS_NET_ACT  1      -      -      -      -
   ±   BS_NET_ACT  2      -      -      -      -
   ±   BS_NET_ACT  3      -      -      -      -
Valid Operations: + PLUS, - MINUS, * TIMES, / DIVIDE BY, % PERCENTAGE OF

Type  Field Name  Description
System AP_LDS_B   Report Control Code B Description
System AP_LDS_C   Report Control Code C Description
System AP_LDS_D   Report Control Code D Description
System AP_LDS_E   Report Control Code E Description
System RUN_DATE   Report Run Date
System RUN_MONTH  Report Run Month
System RUN_TIME   Report Run Time

F3=Return to menu  F4=Prompt  F11=Delete this field  F12=Previous

6-17  SA  MW  K5  CL  IM  DM  II  STUD140  KB  PKH31251
  
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To create the new data dictionary field, enter:

Fields:

Description

Enter a description for the user-defined data dictionary field of up to 50 characters in length.

Length

Enter the number of digits to be printed. This includes decimals, but not the decimal point.

For example, 12345.67 requires a length 7.

The default is 15.

Decimal Places

Enter the number of decimals to be printed, excluding the decimal point. You can leave this blank for no decimal places.

The default is 2.

Op.

The arithmetic operators you can use are as displayed on the screen as (+ - / * %). Calculations are performed left to right. For example, $ab - cd * ef$ is calculated $(ab - cd) * ef$.

You can use up to three fields in a calculation and these may include both system and user-defined fields and constant values.

Field Name

Enter either:

- The name of the data dictionary field (application or user-defined) whose value is to be used.

or:

- A numeric value to be used in the calculation. Negative values are specified with a leading minus (-).

Period Number

The number entered must be between 0 and the number of G/L periods. This defines the period from which values are to be retrieved, if not the reporting period.

If the figure is required from a specific period of the year, enter the actual period number.

Year Modifier

If the period number to be used is not in the current year, you can enter a Year Modifier. For example, to select the closing balance at the end of last year, you would enter the Period Number as 12 and the Year Modifier as 1-.

Period Offset

If the values for the calculation are to be obtained from a period earlier or later than the current period, enter the number of periods by which data should be taken. A trailing minus - indicates an earlier period.

For example, if the value for the calculation is to be retrieved from the month previous to the current period, a period modifier of 1- is entered in the period offset field.

Currency?

Enter the currency in which you want to see values printed in the report.



You may only enter system-defined fields or existing user-defined fields as calculation fields. Roll Up or Down to view the data dictionary fields at the base of the screen, and key them in when required.



Note: Some values may be printed regularly with the sign reversed, especially when processing sales values. To set these up in the data dictionary, multiply the value by minus one.



Note: You may not use the underscore as part of a user-defined field because it is used solely for system-defined fields and identifies them as such.



Having entered the appropriate details, press **Enter** to accept, and the new field will appear within the list of user-defined fields in its alphabetical place.